

HackSoc

Minutes for June 26, 2019

Present: Velvet (Chair), Aaron, Alexi, Alfie, Vajna, Jordan

margins 2019 retrospective

1. Deliver After Action Review - AD

Link to AAR - <https://hacksoc.net/margins-aar>

2. SWOT Analysis - AD

Strengths

Venue was really good - Gender Neutral Loos

Weakness

We had 50% attrition

Running event out of term may have affected turnout

Over provisioning of food and swag

Self-care workshop (afternoon) had a lot of drop outs - only a few attendees

Opportunities

Lots of space to grow in the venue

This year was successful so we can build on top of it

Threats

Due Diligence with Scholarships and Suppliers (Caterer fell through, scholarship given to someone who didn't attend, defunct suppliers)

Speaker drop out - Contingencies were already there in some respect

3. Preparation

Issues with suppliers were handled well, replaced promptly

Getting PLI, Food Safety Certificate should be one of the first things to get from the supplier

Volunteers used effectively outside of the event - Prep

Speakers/Workshop Leaders Getting designated team member - VS

Risk assessment/Health and Safety Concerns - AO

4. During the Event

Issues with Estates/Security was handled well

Over-loaded with volunteers

Lots of idle time

Issues with volunteers cliquing (specifically HackSoc volunteers)

Catering went well

Schedule Changes - VS

People didn't necessarily know who the sponsors were, how to interact with them

Sponsors were put in corners - Refinitiv away from the rest of the venue

Heavy attrition after lunch

Lunch was too long

In future it may make sense to make lunch 30 minutes (split in two slots?)

Weren't enough activities for people to do/mingle around during lunch

5. Recommendations

Marketing Language - VS

Some people didn't comfortable identifying themselves as marginalised, changing the language may be worthwhile.

Pre-event communication

Better communicate

Finances

Would have been good to inform speakers about opportunities to expense local travel

Paying speakers until after refinitiv money has cleared

6. Next Steps - Future margins

Re-use of existing document and forms - VS

Code of Conduct can be re-used for next year

Catering next year - Perhaps use one of the local caterers already involved in BME

Refinitiv has expressed wanting to work together on further workshops and activities in this space

Should 2020 be bigger?

Should continue to aim for 100 attendees

We should keep the cosy feel of the

April 2020? That way it is still nice out but it's also during term

Make some sort of crafting thing to do that gets made as a group in the space

Catering

Breakfast - Lots of people went after the bars and not fruit (perhaps because we're approaching an age where people don't like eating an orange in public)

Swag

We had a lot more swag than needed, most can be reused to an extent

Bags - felt a bit wasteful when putting stuff away at the end - perhaps a stack of swag as a solution in future

Some better communication about "taking a bag" would help resolve the large amount of them left over

Volunteer Hats

They didn't fit particularly

Should keep the head idea (Bandanna, Visor, Beanie?)

People were too comfortable to take them off indoors

Speakers

Have a better way to notify speakers when they have five minutes remaining etc. after the event

Target Audiences in future

Women in Tech Community

BME Communities

Latinx?

Not all groups like using negative (marginalised/discriminated against) language, because they can be more about empowerment

Write ubitem Have a better way to notify speakers when they have five minutes remaining etc. after the event

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Marketing

Make it clearer that it's not just for people who work in Tech

Frame vegan free food as just free food

Using photos on marketing materials